

■ Salesforce Lead Lifecycle — Visual & Story-Based Guide

Follow the journey of a Lead from first contact to becoming a loyal customer. Designed to spark understanding and retention.

1■■ Stage 1 — Lead Captured (Raw Lead)

A potential customer fills out a web form to download an eBook. Salesforce creates a new Lead record automatically.

■ Think: Someone just walked into your virtual store. They're curious, not committed yet.

Field	Value
Lead Source	Website Download
Lead Status	New
Owner	Inbound Marketing Queue

2■■ Stage 2 — Lead Nurturing / Qualification

The assigned Sales Rep, Alice, reviews and contacts the lead. She checks for fit (budget, need, timing).

■ Think: She's figuring out if the visitor is browsing or buying.

Field	Value
Lead Status	Working - Contacted
Lead Rating	Warm
Industry	Manufacturing

3■■ Stage 3 — Lead Qualified (Sales Ready)

Alice confirms BANT (Budget, Authority, Need, Timeline). The Lead is now qualified to convert.

■ Think: The shopper is now serious — time to move from interest to action.

Field	Value
Lead Status	Qualified
Lead Score	85
Trigger	Convert to Account/Contact/Opportunity

4■■■ Stage 4 — Conversion

Salesforce automatically creates related records: Account, Contact, and Opportunity. The Lead becomes part of the sales pipeline.

■ **Think:** The visitor became a customer file — now the real deal begins.

New Record	Source Field	Example
Account	Company	Titan Manufacturing
Contact	Name & Email	John Matthews (john@titanmfg.com)
Opportunity	Lead Name	Titan Manufacturing - IoT Pilot Project

5■■■ Stage 5 — Opportunity Management

The sales cycle continues — quotes, negotiation, and closure. Winning the deal turns the company into a client.

■ **Think:** The salesperson closes the deal — the handshake moment.

Stage	Outcome
Proposal/Price Quote	Sent quote to client
Negotiation	Agreed on pricing
Closed Won	Deal secured, client onboarding begins

6■■■ Stage 6 — Closed Lost or Nurture Again

If the deal falls through, Salesforce can reassign the Contact to a nurture campaign, ensuring future re-engagement.

■ **Think:** The conversation pauses, not ends — marketing keeps the relationship alive.

■ Summary — Lead Lifecycle Flow

Stage	Record Type	Automation Trigger
1■■■ Captured	Lead	Assignment Rules
2■■■ Contacted	Lead	Activity Tracking
3■■■ Qualified	Lead	Conversion Trigger
4■■■ Converted	Account + Contact + Opportunity	Record Linking
5■■■ Opportunity	Opportunity	Pipeline Management
6■■■ Nurture	Lead/Contact	Marketing Campaign

■ **Mnemonic:** Lead = Interest → Conversion = Contact → Opportunity = Deal → Customer = Relationship.